SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION 1

Table 1 *The Newcastle-Ottawa Scale: study quality assessment [14]*

Criteria	Burjonrappa [18]	Demirogullari [15]	Heikenen [16]	van den Berg [17]
Selection[1]				
1. Representativeness of the exposed cohort	-	★	-	★
2. Selection of the non-exposed cohort	-	-	-	-
3. Ascertainment of exposure	-	★	★	★
4. Demonstration that outcome of interest was not present at start of study	-	★	★	-
Comparability[2]				
1. Comparability of cohorts on the basis of the design or analysis	-	-	-	-
Outcome[3]				
1. Assessment of outcome	-	-	-	★
2. Was follow-up long enough for outcomes to occur	★	★	★	★
3. Adequacy of follow up of cohorts	-	★	★	★
Assessment	*Poor*	*Poor*	*Poor*	*Poor*

[1] **Selection**: (1) *Representativeness of the exposed cohort*: A, truly representative ★; B, somewhat representative ★; C, selected group; and D, no description of the derivation of the cohort. (2*) Selection of the nonexposed cohort*: A, drawn from the same community as the exposed cohort ★; B, drawn from a different source; and C, no description of the derivation of the non-exposed cohort. (3) *Ascertainment of exposure*: A, secure record (e.g., surgical records) ★; B, structured interview ★; C, written self-report; D, no description, and E, other. (4) *Demonstration that outcome of interest was not present at start of study*: A, yes ★; B, no.

[2] **Comparability**: *Comparability of cohorts on the basis of the design or analysis*: A, study controls for age ★; B, study controls for other factors (such as treatment type) ★; and C, cohorts are not comparable on the basis of the design or analysis controlled for confounders.

[3] **Outcome**: (1) *Assessment of outcome*: A, independent blind assessment ★; B, record linkage ★; C, self-report; D, no description, and E, other. (2) *Was follow-up long enough for outcomes to occur*: A, yes ★; B, no. (3) *Adequacy of follow up of cohorts*: A, complete follow-up - all subjects accounted for ★; B, subjects lost to follow up unlikely to introduce bias (loss ≤20%) or description provided of those lost no different from those followed ★; C, follow up rate <80% and no description of those lost; and D, no statement.

Systematic review: post-operative colonic manometry in children with anorectal malformations